NOT MEASUREMENT SENSITIVE

MIL-DTL-3943/9E
1 May 1997
SUPERSEDING
MIL-D-3943/9D
24 June 1994

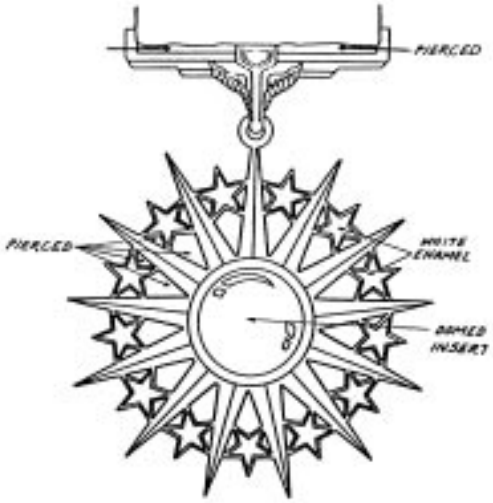
DETAIL SPECIFICATION SHEET

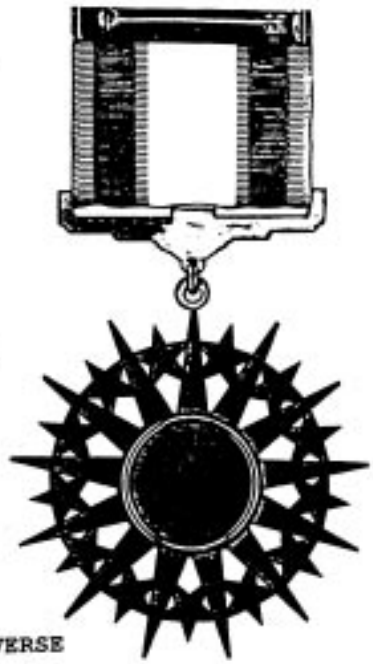
DECORATION, DISTINGUISHED SERVICE MEDAL, AIR FORCE

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

The requirements for acquiring the product described herein shall consist of this specification sheet and the issue of MIL-DTL-3943 listed in that issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) specified in the solicitation.

OBVERSE





REVERSE

DASH NO.
-1: Regular Size
-2: Miniature Size

MATERIAL: Gilding Metal

FINISH: Hard Enameled, Gold Plated, Matte Finish and shall match TIOH Metal Finish Chip Number 7.

AMSC N/A FSC 8455

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:44Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

DIMENSIONS:

PENDANT:

HEIGHT (Including Lug):
-1: 2-1/4 inches (5.72 cm) (REF)
-2: 1-3/16 inches (3.02 cm) (REF)

WIDTH (Overall):
-1: 2-1/8 inches (5.40 cm) (REF)
-2: 1-1/16 inches (2.70 cm) (REF)

THICKNESS (At Thickest Point):
-1: 0.190 inch ± 0.010 inch (0.483 cm ± 0.025 cm)
-2: 0.115 inch ± 0.010 inch (0.292 cm ± 0.025 cm)

SUSPENSION BAR:

HEIGHT (Overall):
-1: 19/32 inch (1.51 cm) (REF)
-2: 5/16 inch (0.79 cm) (REF)

WIDTH (Overall):
-1: 1-19/32 inch (4.05 cm) (REF)
-2: 25/32 inch (1.98 cm) (REF)

THICKNESS (At Thickest Point):
-1: 0.095 inch ± 0.010 inch (0.241 cm ± 0.025 cm)
-2: 0.065 inch ± 0.010 inch (0.165 cm ± 0.025 cm)

NOTES:

1. The term (REF) refers to the measurements taken from the Government furnished hub or die

2. Piercing shall be as indicated. For Dash No. -2, the area around the star is not pierced.

3. Enameled color shall be white as indicated. The enamel color shall conform to TIOH chip number 28 or the standard sample.

4. Epoxy resin (stoning epoxy) may be used in lieu of hard enamel at the option of the manufacturer.

5. The center device shall consist of a plastic insert cemented to the pendant using a cellulose ester cement. The plastic insert shall be 43/64 inch (1.71 cm) in diameter for Dash No. -1 and 21/64 inch (0.83 cm) in diameter for Dash No. -2. Prior to cementing the insert in place, the entire bottom of the recess in the pendant shall be covered with an aluminum reflecting shield 0.010 inch ± 0.002 inch (0.025 cm ± 0.005 cm) in thickness.

6. The plastic insert shall have a constant minimum thickness of 0.060 inch (0.152 cm) and shall be domed to a radius of 0.720 inch (1.83 cm) for Dash No. -1 and 0.400 inch (1.016 cm) for Dash No. -2. The color of the plastic shall be blue and shall match the color of the plastic of the standard sample.

7. A ring formed from bronze wire shall be soldered on the vertical center line of the suspension bar. The center of the ring shall be located 7/64 inch + 1/32 inch - 0 (0.28 cm + 0.08 cm - 0) from the bottom of the suspension bar for Dash No. -1 and 1/16 inch + 1/32 inch - 0 (0.16 cm + 0.08 cm - 0) for Dash No. -2. The ring for Dash No. 1 shall be formed from 0.065 inch ± 0.002 inch (0.165 cm ± 0.005 cm) wire and shall

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:44Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

have an outside diameter of 7/32 inch ± 1/64 inch (0.56 cm ± 0.04 cm). The ring for Dash No. 2 shall be formed from 0.031 inch ± 0.002 inch (0.079 cm ± 0.005) wire and shall have an outside diameter of 1/8 inch ± 1/64 inch (0.32 cm ± 0.04 cm).

8. Decoration set shall consist of a regular size medal, a service ribbon, a rosette and a lapel button all packaged in a presentation case conforming to MIL-DTL-14633 Type V, Style 5 with a Class 1 or 1A pad.

9. The ribbon for the pendant drape and service ribbon shall conform to MIL-DTL-11589/51.

10. The rosette shall conform to MIL-DTL-14649/19.

11. The lapel button shall conform to MIL-DTL-11484/70.

CHANGES FROM PREVIOUS ISSUE: Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extent of the changes.

Custodians:
Army - IH
Air Force - 45

Preparing activity:
Army - IH

Review activities:
Air Force - 32, 82, 99
DLA - CT

(Project No. 8455-0887)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T22:44Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.